THE LONG ROAD TO VICTORY

With 10 teams in action, each team gets to play nine matches. Over the course of a month, the Indian team will travel to nine different venues in the league stages. Can it capitalise on the home advantage?

–Rahul Rawat

1 SUN. OCT. 8
IST 2:00 PM

vs Australia

M.A. Chidambaram Stadium, Chennai

India begins its quest for a third title against the five-time champions on a traditionally spin-friendly wicket. India did well against the Aussies in the recently-concluded home series, but the last time they met in Chennai in March, Australia won.

2 WED. OCT. 11
IST 2:00 PM

vs Afghanistan

Arun Jaitley Stadium, New Delhi

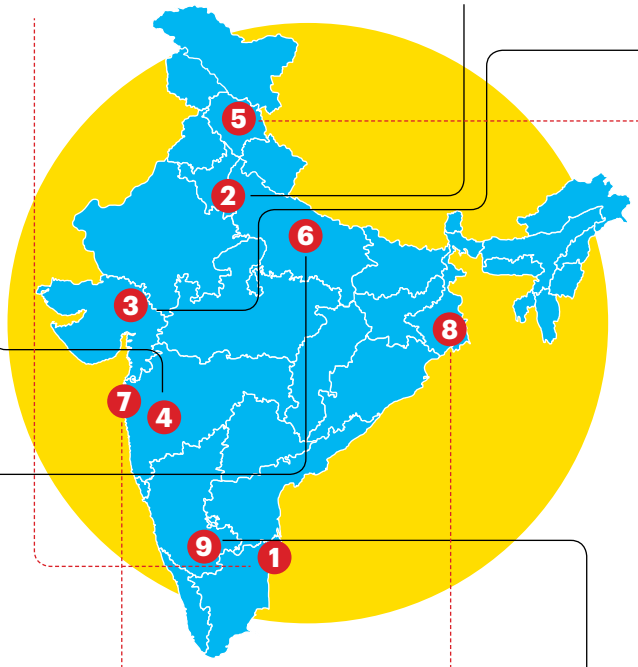
India will be favourites as they play Afghanistan at a venue they haven't lost an ODI match in since 1982. Spinners rule the roost in Delhi, where the ball keeps low. The short boundaries, though, always keep the batters in with a chance.

3 SAT. OCT. 14
IST 2:00 PM

vs Pakistan

Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad

The marquee clash unfolds at the world's largest stadium, which also hosts the final. The wicket will offer runs; pacers can extract pace and bounce. India have done well here, boding well for a team that beat Pakistan at the Asia Cup.



4 THU. OCT. 19
IST 2:00 PM

vs Bangladesh

Maharashtra Cricket Association Stadium, Pune

The higher-ranked hosts go in as favourites on a wicket where the Indian batters should enjoy playing their strokes. India's last victory here came against Sri Lanka, albeit in a T20I contest.

5 SUN. OCT. 22
IST 2:00 PM

vs New Zealand

Himachal Pradesh Cricket Association Stadium, Dharamshala

A high-altitude venue where the pacers will get zip and movement off the wicket. The relaid outfield was not ready in March 2023, which is why a Test match against Australia was shifted to Indore.

6 SUN. OCT. 29
IST 2:00 PM

vs England

Atal Bihari Vajpayee Ekana Cricket Stadium, Lucknow

The team's test against the defending champions is at a ground where they have played one ODI—losing to S. Africa in Oct. 2022. In IPL 2023, Lucknow was infamous for its low scores, forcing authorities to prepare a fresh pitch for the WC.

7 THU. NOV. 2
IST 2:00 PM

vs Sri Lanka

Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai

Wankhede has been a mixed bag for Team India in recent years but it's also where we were crowned champions. Expect a high-scoring contest because that's what the nature of wickets has been in Mumbai, always.

8 SUN. NOV. 5
IST 2:00 PM

vs South Africa

Eden Gardens, Kolkata

One of India's most iconic venues will host a contest against the tricky South Africa. The ball moves around a bit here and with dew being a factor, the toss assumes importance, as it will be difficult to grip the ball in the second innings.

9 SUN. NOV. 12
IST 2:00 PM

vs Netherlands

M. Chinnaswamy Stadium, Bengaluru

With a 14:4 win-loss ratio in ODIs at the Chinnaswamy, India's last group match is against the weakest team of all. One can expect India to post a mammoth total if they bat first, as the Bengaluru wicket has always been a bowlers' graveyard.